

Clinical Study Data Reviewer's Guide

Study ABC-01

Protocol	ABC-01
Title	A Phase 2 Study of Drug A versus Placebo
Standard	SDTMIG v3.3 (SDTM v1.7)
Define-XML	v2.0
Prepared	2026-07-20
Status	DRAFT - synthetic training data

All data in this study is synthetic. No real patients, sites, investigators, sponsors or products are represented. This document is a teaching artifact produced for a clinical programming course and is not a regulatory submission.

1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose

This Clinical Study Data Reviewer's Guide (cSDRG) describes the SDTM datasets submitted for study ABC-01. It is intended to help a reviewer locate and understand the data without needing to contact the study team. It complements, and does not repeat, the machine-readable metadata in define.xml: where define.xml states *what* each variable is, this guide explains *why* the data looks the way it does.

1.2 Acronyms

Acronym	Meaning
aCRF	Annotated Case Report Form
CDISC	Clinical Data Interchange Standards Consortium
CT	Controlled Terminology
cSDRG	Clinical Study Data Reviewer's Guide
MedDRA	Medical Dictionary for Regulatory Activities
SDTM	Study Data Tabulation Model
SDTMIG	SDTM Implementation Guide
WHODrug	World Health Organization Drug Dictionary

1.3 Study Data Standards and Dictionary Inventory

Standard / Dictionary	Version
SDTM	1.7
SDTM Implementation Guide	3.3
CDISC Controlled Terminology	current at time of preparation
Define-XML	2.0

Standard / Dictionary	Version
MedDRA	ILLUSTRATIVE ONLY - see section 3.3
WHODrug	ILLUSTRATIVE ONLY - see section 3.3

2. Protocol Description

2.1 Protocol Number and Title

ABC-01 - A Phase 2 Study of Drug A versus Placebo.

2.2 Study Design

ABC-01 is a randomised, double-blind, placebo-controlled Phase 2 study. Eight subjects were enrolled at two sites (01 and 02) and randomised 1:1 to Drug A 50 mg or matching placebo, taken orally once daily for approximately four weeks. Subjects were assessed at Screening, Baseline and Week 4. Seven subjects completed; one subject (ABC-01-01-004) discontinued early due to an adverse event.

2.3 Study Design in Relation to SDTM

The design maps to SDTM without special handling. There is a single treatment period and no crossover, so each subject has one dosing record in EX and a single set of reference dates in DM. Trial Design domains (TS, TA, TE, TV) are outside the scope of this training submission and are not included.

3. Subject Data Description

3.1 Overview

Eight subjects are represented in DM. All subject-level datasets use USUBJID as the unique key, constructed as STUDYID-SITEID-SUBJID (for example ABC-01-01-001), because SUBJID is only unique within a site.

3.2 Annotated CRF

The annotated CRF (ABC-01_Sample_CRF.pdf) is submitted alongside the datasets and is linked from define.xml. It annotates all 62 collected fields with their SDTM destinations. Fields that are collected but not submitted are annotated as such - see section 3.5.

3.3 Dictionary Coding

Coded terms in this study are illustrative and are not the output of a licensed dictionary. AEDECOD values resemble MedDRA Preferred Terms and CMDECOD values resemble WHODrug preferred names, but they were assigned for teaching purposes. In a real submission these are produced by trained coders against licensed dictionary versions, which would be stated in section 1.3.

3.4 Subject Data Tabulation Datasets

Dataset	Label	Class	Structure	Records	Variables
DM	Demographics	Special Purpose	One record per subject	8	23
DS	Disposition	Events	One record per disposition event per subject	24	9
EX	Exposure	Interventions	One record per dosing period per subject	8	13
AE	Adverse Events	Events	One record per event per subject	10	14
SUPPAE	Supplemental Qualifiers for Relationship	Relationship	One record per qualifier per parent record	10	10
CM	Concomitant Medications	Interventions	One record per medication per subject	8	15
VS	Vital Signs	Findings	One record per test per visit per subject	128	16
LB	Laboratory Test Results	Findings	One record per test per visit per subject	48	22

Record counts are read directly from the submitted datasets.

3.5 Collected but Not Submitted

Three CRF fields are collected for site workflow and have no SDTM destination. They are annotated on the aCRF as not submitted:

CRF field	Form	Why it is not submitted
EXINTP	Drug Accountability	Dosing interruption is represented structurally, by splitting exposure into separate EX records.
VSND	Vital Signs	'Not done' is represented by the absence of a record in a tall structure.
EOSOTH	Disposition	Free-text 'other' detail not required for tabulation.

3.6 Data Relationships

SUPPAE holds one supplemental qualifier, AETRTEM (Treatment Emergent Flag), linked to its parent AE record by USUBJID and IDVAR/IDVARVAL (AESEQ). AETRTEM is derived as AESTDY >= 1, that is, the event started on or after the date of first dose. Nine of ten events are treatment emergent; one event

(ABC-01-01-002, AESEQ 1) began during screening and is flagged N.

No RELREC dataset is submitted; there are no formally asserted record-level relationships beyond SUPPAE.

4. Data Conformance Summary

4.1 Conformance Inputs

Input	Detail
Validation tool	Not run - see note below
SDTM IG version	3.3
Define-XML	v2.0, generated from the study mapping specification

Note. A real submission would report the validation tool and rule-set version here (for example Pinnacle 21 with the FDA rule set) together with every finding. This training study has not been run through a commercial validator. The datasets were instead checked with a purpose-written conformance suite covering key integrity, required-variable completeness, controlled terminology and value logic, plus a value-level comparison against a known reference.

4.2 Issues Summary

No unresolved conformance issues. The following are expected characteristics of this study that a reviewer might otherwise query:

Observation	Explanation
Two subjects have no AE records	Subjects ABC-01-01-003 and ABC-01-02-004 reported no adverse events. Absence of a record is correct.
Four subjects have no LB records	Laboratory samples were drawn for a subset of subjects per protocol.
VISITNUM 3 is not used	The protocol visit schedule includes a visit at which no vital signs or laboratory samples are taken. Visits are numbered sequentially.
Negative study days in CM and DS	Concomitant medications started before first dose, and informed consent and randomisation preceded first dose.
RFPENDTC populated from DS	End of participation is taken from the disposition form, not demographics.
One abnormal laboratory result	Subject ABC-01-01-003 has an elevated ALT at Week 4 (72 U/L, reference 7-56). No corresponding clinical finding.

5. Appendix - Submission Contents

Component	File(s)
Tabulation datasets	dm.xpt, ds.xpt, ex.xpt, ae.xpt, suppaexpt, cm.xpt, vs.xpt, lb.xpt
Metadata	define.xml (with define2-0-0.xsl stylesheet)
Annotated CRF	ABC-01_Sample_CRF.pdf
Reviewer's guide	cSDRG_ABC-01.pdf (this document)

End of document. Synthetic training data - not for regulatory use.